Jurassic English™

LEVEL 2: DEVELOPMENT

Curriculum Model — **10 Core Texts · 40 Lessons · Academic Year 2026–2027**

Ages 8–10 · CEFR A1 → A2

Level Overview

THE TRANSITION YEAR

What Makes Level 2 Different

Level 2 marks the **transition from oral to written reasoning**. Students begin constructing written CEIW structures for the first time, with extensive scaffolding.

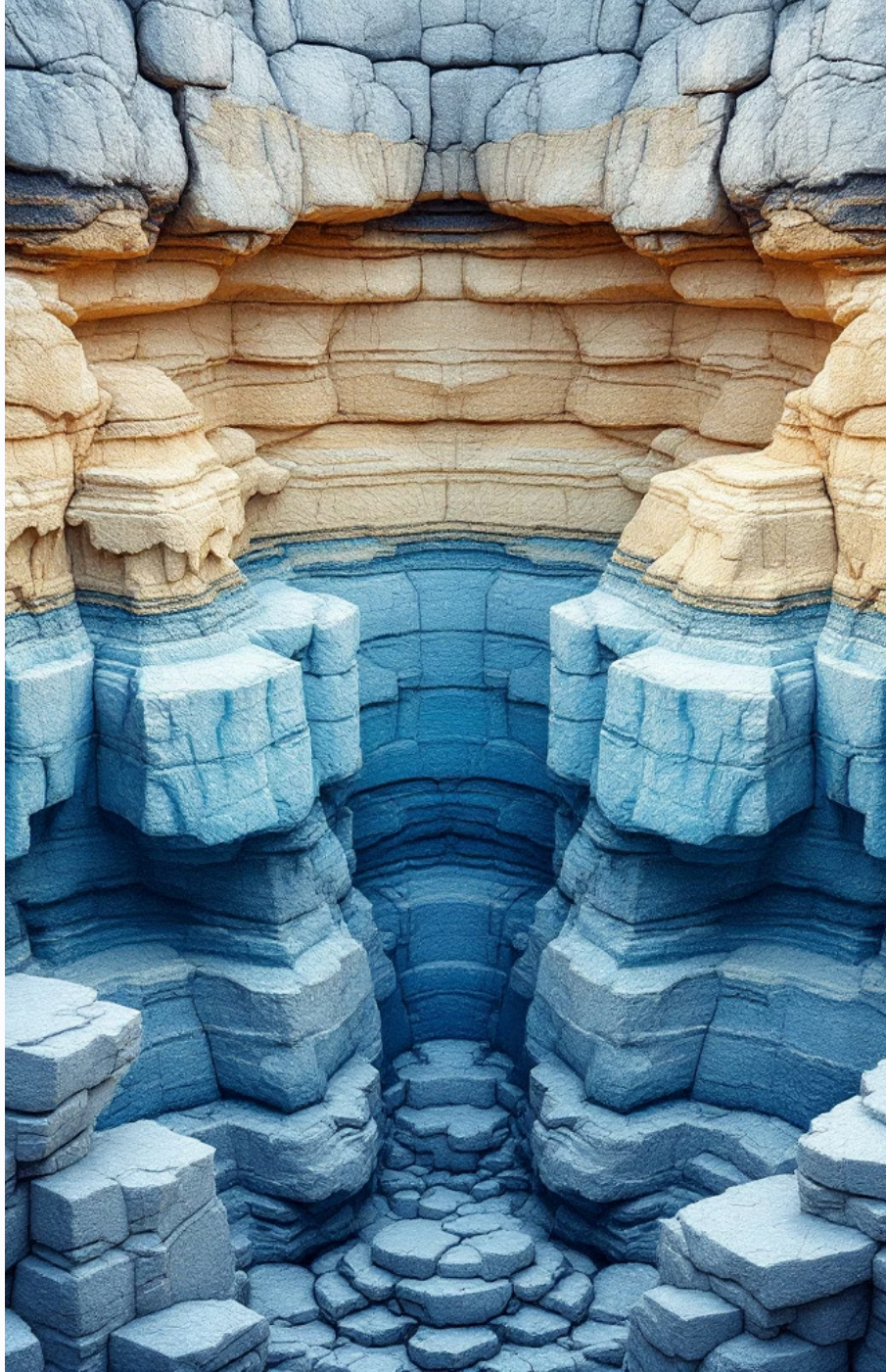
The core texts introduce **early moral dilemmas** — situations where two valid positions exist — because moral ambiguity is the engine of Accountable Talk. When there is a clear right answer, there is nothing to argue about.

Regulation Transfer

Regulation at this level begins to transfer from **teacher-led** to **student-initiated**.

By the end of Level 2, students should be able to:

- Identify when they are dysregulated
- Independently select a regulation strategy
- Attempt academic discourse with self-regulation in place



The Four-Lesson Cycle at Level 2

Each of the 10 core texts is explored through a structured **4-lesson archaeological cycle** — from excavation of meaning to ecological impact.

Lesson 1: Excavation

Analyze

Vocabulary archaeology; surface and character analysis; T-chart building

Lesson 2: Strata

Evaluate

The Socratic Press; assigned-opposite-position debate; first moral divergence

Lesson 3: The Justification

Justify

First full written CEIW with scaffold; warrant as the distinguishing step

Lesson 4: The Impact

Reflect

Ecological extension; connecting text meaning to real ecosystems and communities

Core Text List: Texts 1–5

1	**Charlotte's Web — E.B. White** A1–A2 · Ages 8–10 Sacrifice, mortality, and ecological interdependence; Charlotte as the most complex character at this level
2	**The Wild Robot — Peter Brown** A2 · Ages 8–10 Identity and environment; ecological integration; what it means to "belong" to a place — strong ecocentric text
3	**James and the Giant Peach — Roald Dahl** A1–A2 · Ages 8–10 Escape from oppression; community-building; metaphorical reading of the peach as a world
4	**The Little Prince — Antoine de Saint-Exupéry** A2 · Ages 8–10 The most philosophically rich text at this level; essential prep for Level 3 ambiguity work
5	**Pippi Longstocking — Astrid Lindgren** A1–A2 · Ages 8–9 Non-conformity and social expectation; first introduction to the unreliable social contract

Core Text List: Texts 6–10

1	**The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe — C.S. Lewis** A2 · Ages 8–10 Moral courage; betrayal and redemption; allegory — first encounter with metaphorical reading
2	**My Father's Dragon — Ruth Stiles Gannett** A1 · Ages 8–9 Problem-solving narrative; first structured inference from character behaviour
3	**The Enormous Crocodile — Roald Dahl** A1 · Ages 7–9 Simple moral reasoning; deception and consequence; fast-paced enough for oral Socratic discussion
4	**The Bear Who Wanted to Be a Forest** A2 · Ages 8–10 Identity vs. conformity; ecological self; individual desire versus community need
5	**Stuart Little — E.B. White** A1–A2 · Ages 8–10 Belonging and difference; courage in the face of improbability; precursor to Levels 3–4 themes

Texts 6–10 complete the full 40-lesson arc. Each text is paired with a 4-lesson cycle: Excavation → Strata → Justification → Impact.

CEIW at Level 2: The First Written Argument

First full written CEIW — extensively scaffolded. This is the defining milestone of Level 2.

C — CLAIM

"The Bear's desire to change is _____ (harmful / natural / selfish) for the forest because _____."

E — EVIDENCE

"In the text, it says: '___'. / The Bear [does/says] ___."

I — INTERPRETATION

"This shows that the Bear's change _____ the balance of the forest by _____."

W — WARRANT

"When individuals change the ecosystem around them to suit themselves, it causes _____ because the forest depends on each part staying in its role."

Assessment Focus

- → Is the **Claim** contestable?
- → Is the **Evidence** a direct quote?
- → Does the **Warrant** make a logical bridge?

Accountable Talk at Level 2

Key Moves Introduced at This Level

Marking

"What [student name] just said is important — can you say more about that?"

Pressing

"But have you considered...?"

Extending

"Can anyone add to what [student] said with evidence from the text?"

Classroom Implementation

Accountable Talk card on every desk during:

- Strata (Lesson 2) — The Socratic Press phase
- Impact (Lesson 4) — Ecological reflection phase

Prompt card language students are **expected to use independently** by end of Level 2.

The goal: discourse moves become habitual, not prompted.

Reasoning Progression at Level 2

Level 2 spans a critical band of cognitive development — from foundational recall to the first steps of ecocentric moral reasoning.

Reasoning Level 2: Foundation

Recall applied to cause-and-effect — the foundation for evaluation

Reasoning Levels 3–4: First Written Construction

First formal written Claim-Evidence construction; warrant as the distinguishing step

Reasoning Levels 4–5: Perspective-Taking

Evaluating an argument from an assigned position — the Socratic Press

Reasoning Levels 5–6 (Intro): Ecocentric Thinking

The non-human environment as having moral standing — introduced here, deepened in Level 3

Exit Standard CEFR A2: Student can write a CEIW paragraph with Claim, Evidence, and Warrant — with scaffold support.

Differentiation at Level 2

Every student accesses the same rich texts and moral dilemmas — differentiation adjusts the **scaffold level**, not the intellectual demand.

Support

Pre-filled Evidence column. Students write Claim and Warrant only.

Sentence stems on laminated cards. Peer scribe permitted.

Core

Full written CEIW with scaffold.

Accountable Talk cards in active use throughout Strata and Impact phases.

Extension

Dual CEIW — one argument FOR and one AGAINST, then a final sentence explaining which is stronger and why.

This is the **precursor to Level 3 divergence thinking**.

Year at a Glance

ACADEMIC YEAR 2026–2027

40

Total Lessons

10 texts × 4-lesson cycles

10

Core Texts

Spanning A1 to A2 CEFR

3

Terms

Progressive scaffold reduction

Term 1

Oral CEIW with written Claim. Regulation transfer begins. Teacher-led scaffolding dominant.

Term 2

Scaffolded written CEIW. Accountable Talk cards introduced. Student-initiated regulation emerging.

Term 3

Reduced scaffold. Warrant focus. Student-initiated regulation expected. Exit standard assessed.

Assessment Portfolio

Written CEIW Paragraphs

Collected across all three terms showing scaffold reduction over time

Accountable Talk Records

Participation records from Strata and Impact phases

Exit Writings

End-of-cycle written responses demonstrating CEFR A2 exit standard